

matter. It was the era of Donald Glover and Lady Gaga after all. I was meant to make millions by the time I was 25. (To be “25 sitting on 25 mil,” as Drake put it.)

On the rare occasions that I logged into Bank of America online, I would peek at the number in my checking account and then close it quickly like it was an ancient cursed book. I overdrafted constantly. Every time I ran out of money, my mom would, behind my dad’s back, put fifty bucks into my account to cover the \$30 overdraft fee and give me twenty bucks to play with. (Love, but also enabling!) The boat kept filling with water, and I kept trying to drain it with a thimble.

I talked about this with NO ONE. I figured everyone I knew was doing the same thing, racking up credit card debt and praying for a light at the end of the tunnel.

My mental health spiraled downward. My shakiness and anxiety hadn’t fully subsided since the summer, and so I decided it couldn’t hurt to look into medical help beyond talk therapy. In winter 2012, I started seeing a very cheap, pay-as-you-can psychiatrist who prescribed me Klonopin and Celexa. The combo made me fall asleep in the shower and bruise my head. On this medication cocktail, I was exhausted. I slept for days. I missed work. My roommate called my parents. I’d been acting like a zombie and was speaking incoherently.

One night, I woke up in a haze with my dad standing over me. He’d flown from South Florida to bring me home. I didn’t want to go. I had comedy shows to perform. I had to try to go back to work. My dad did not give me a choice about it. The next day, he essentially forced me onto a plane to Fort Lauderdale for my own good.

I spent the next month in a parentally devised “rehab.” I went off the meds I’d been on. I saw and spoke to almost no one other than my family members, my dad’s AA friends, and a yoga instructor. Every morning, my mom woke me up at 6:00 a.m. and dragged me to kundalini yoga (the deep breathing kind). She forced me to eat bananas and cereal while I shook violently. At lunchtime, she forced me to eat a small sandwich. In the evenings, I’d go with my dad to AA, or